NUREDIN ALI

PhD Student, University of Minnesota
ali00530@umn.edu
Website ◇ Google Scholar

EDUCATION

University of Minnesota Aug 2022 - Present
PhD student; Computer Science
College of Science and Engineering Fellowship (3 years)
Advisor: Stevie Chancellor (PhD)

University of Minnesota Aug 2022 - Dec 2025
Master of Science; Computer Science

Mekelle University Sep 2016 - Dec 2020
Bachelor of Science; Information Systems GPA: 3.96/4.0

Research Areas: Ethical and human-centered machine learning, human computer interaction (HCI), social media platforms, and its application to high-risk mental health behaviors, and the mental health of digital data workers.

EMPLOYMENT

Distributed AI Research Institute (DAIR) Summer 2023, 2024, 2025
Research Intern
Mentors: Timnit Gebru (PhD), Alex Hanna (PhD), Zeerak Talat (PhD), Dylan Baker

Chapa Financial Technologies S.C June 2021 - June 2022
Machine Learning, Researcher
Mentors: Israel Goytom

Lesan.ai Summer 2019, 2020
Machine Learning, Intern
Mentors: Asmelash Teka (PhD)

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Nomination to Google PhD Fellowship **1 of 4 from the whole University**, University of Minnesota. 2026
- Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship **1 Year Fellowship**, University of Minnesota. 2026
- Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews - ACM CHI 2026
- College of Science and Engineering (CSE) **3 Year Fellowship**, University of Minnesota. 2022
- Robert E. Greiling Jr. Fellowship, University of Minnesota. Amount: $6000 USD. 2022
- CS-IDEA Fellowship, University of Minnesota. Amount: $1538 USD. 2022
- 1st place winner of Blackathon. A hackathon organized by Black American researchers. 2021
- Selected to Engineering For Developing Communities. **(1.6% acceptance rate)** 2019
- Top 10 Best Students of the year award (High School). **(1.5% acceptance rate)** 2015

CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

* refers to equal contribution

Peer-reviewed conferences are top-tier publication venues in HCI and computer science. They are highly selective, extensively reviewed, and intended for archival papers only. When available, the acceptance rate is included.

Online-Offline: The Spread of Anti-Tigrayan Hate on X During the 2020-2022 Tigrayan Genocide
[under submission]
Nuredin Ali, Dylan Baker, Meron Estefanos, Fasica Berhane, Zecharias Zelalem, Messai Ali, Rishan Berhe, Zeerak Talat, Alex Hanna, Timnit Gebru
20th International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM) 2027.

FedMental: Evaluating Federated Learning For Mental Health Detection from Social Media Data
[paper] [Main Conference]
Nuredin Ali, Anjali Ratnam, Zeerak Talat, Stevie Chancellor
The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL 2026). [19%]

Beyond Content Exposure: Systemic Factors Driving Moderators' Mental Health Crisis in Africa [paper]
Nuredin Ali, Tianling Yang, Shivani Kapania, Kauna Malgwi, Fasica Berhane, Adio-adet Dinka, Elaine O.Nsoesie, Milagros Miceli, Stevie Chancellor
Accepted at ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2026. [25.3%]

'The plan is just survival': Data Work in Kenya and the Regime of Entrapment [paper]
Shivani Kapania, Tianling Yang, Nuredin Ali, Morgan Klaus Scheuerman, Milagros Miceli, Alex Taylor, Sarah Fox
Accepted at ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2026. [25.3%]

Into the Void: Understanding Online Health Information in Low-Web Data Languages [paper]
Hellina Hailu Nigatu, Nuredin Ali, Fiker Tewelde, Stevie Chancellor, Daricia Wilkinson
8th AAAI/ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society, 2025. [31.8%]

Secondary Stakeholders in AI: Fighting for, Brokering, and Navigating Agency [paper]
Leah Hope Ajmani, Nuredin Ali, Stevie Chancellor
ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT) 2025. [26.8%]

The Role of Expertise in Effectively Moderating Harmful Social Media Content [paper]
Nuredin Ali, Tianling Yang, Shivani Kapania, Meron Estefanos, Fasica Berhane, Zecharias Zelalem, Messai Ali, Rishan Berhe, Dylan Baker, Zeerak Talat, Milagros Miceli, Alex Hanna, Timnit Gebru
ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI) 2025. [27.0%]

Diverse Perspectives, Divergent Models: Cross-Cultural Evaluation of Depression Detection on Twitter [paper]
Nuredin Ali, Charles Chuankai Zhang, Ned Mayo, Stevie Chancellor
The Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL) 2024 Main Conference. [23.2%]

WORKSHOP PUBLICATIONS

* refers to equal contribution

These workshop publications are lightly peer-reviewed submissions compared to conference submissions.

Error Analysis of Tigrinya-English Machine Translation Systems [link]
Negais Haile*, Nuredin Ali*, Asmelash Teka
ICLR 2023 Workshop on AfricaNLP.

Machine Learning Models Evaluation and Feature Importance Analysis on Non Performing Loans [link]
Rufael Fekadu*, Anteneh Getachew*, Yishak Tadele*, Nuredin Ali*, Israel Goytom
NeurIPS 2021 Workshop on Machine Learning for Development (ML4D)

Banknote Recognition for Visually Impaired People (Case of Ethiopian note) [link]
Nuredin Ali
NeurIPS 2021 Workshop on Machine Learning for Development (ML4D)

Exploring Transfer Learning on Face Recognition of Dark Skinned, Low Quality and Low Resource Face Data [link]
Nuredin Ali
NeurIPS 2020 at Black in AI (BAI) Workshop.

PRESS COVERAGE

- MacArthur Foundation Grantee Coverage - Interview Snippet on our Research on Content Moderation - **MacArthur Coverage** [Article] August, 2026
- France 24 - LIVE Interview Covering our Content Moderation and Mental Health Research - **France 24 LIVE** [Live Interview] May, 2026
- African Content Moderators Have Worse Mental Health than Global Peers, Study Finds - **TIME** [Article] March, 2026
- 'In the end, you feel blank': India's female workers watching hours of abusive content to train AI - **The Guardian** [Article] Feb, 2026
- Africa has thousands of languages. Can AI be trained on all of them? - **CNN** [Article] Dec, 2025
- AI surveillance and data colonialism shape African conflicts - **AFRICA IN FACT** [Issue 74 – Page 28] – [Article] July, 2025
- What a new study reveals about content moderation in Tigray - **Tech Policy Press** [Article] May, 2025
- Social Media is encouraging a new "all out war" between Ethiopia and Eritrea, researchers warn - **People of Color in Tech** [Article] May, 2025
- Social media platforms "failed to adequately moderate genocidal content" during Tigray war, study finds - **Addis Standard** [Article] May, 2025
- Interview with **Tighat Media** discussing our work on Expertise, Social Media, and Content Moderation. [interview video] May, 2025
- Situation Report - **Europe External Programme with Africa** [Article] April, 2025
- AI research group warns social media hate speech risks reigniting Ethiopia-Eritrea war - **The Eastleigh Voice** [Article] April, 2025
- Kenyan lawsuit against Meta will test big tech accountability - **Compiler News** [Article] April, 2025
- Long interview with **Voice of America (VOA) Tigrinya** discussing our work on Harmful Social Media Content and Mental Health prediction in my native language Tigrinya. [interview video] October, 2024

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

CSci 4131 (Section 001, Fall 2025) Internet Programming Fall 2025
Graduate Teaching Assistant

· Class Size: 180 students.

IT Essentials, ICT Agency of Setit Humera Summer 2025
Lecturer

· Class Size: 40 students.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Associate Editor (AC)

- ICLR Tiny Papers a DEI initiative. 2023 (x8), 2024 (x10)

Conference and Journal Reviewing

- The Deep Learning Indaba 2026 (x4)
- ACM Conference on AI, Ethics, and Society (AIES) 2025 (x1)
- ACM CHI conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI). 2024 (x1), 2025 (x2)
- International Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM). 2023, 2024 (x2), 2025 (x2)
- Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) Ethics. 2024 (x4), 2025 (x5)
- ICLR AfricaNLP Workshop. 2023
- ICLR Machine Learning for Global Health (MLGH) Workshop. 2023

Mentored Students

- Sofia Cirrincione (MSc thesis) – 2025
- Anjali Ratnam (MSc) – 2024 – (then a Software Engineer at Microsoft).
- Ned Mayo (BSc) – 2024

Other Services

- Committee Member of CS-IDEA at the University of Minnesota. Committee Member. 2024
- Black in AI (BAI) Academic Program. Graduate School Application Mentor. 2023, 2024
- Tigray Community in Minnesota (TCMN). Leadership Board Member. Two years. 2023-2025
- Development Work Group at Mechanism Design for Social Good (MD4SG). Co-organizer. 2023
- Head of ICT at School Association, Mekelle University Sep 2019 - Feb 2020
  - Led and organized a student group to present and discuss trending IT fields, including Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning.
- Engineering for Developing Communities, Mekelle, Ethiopia July 2019 - Aug 2019
  - *Summer Research Program.* Participated in an international summer research program, offered in collaboration between Technion University of Israel and Mekelle Institute of Technology, focused on developing and implementing community-based problem-solving projects.
- Member of University Parliament, Mekelle University Sep 2017 - Dec 2020
  - *Students Representative of Information Systems Department.* Served as one of 40 annual representatives on the University Cafeteria Committee, overseeing food quality and campus facilities for approximately 5,000 students at the Main Campus.

Languages and Hobbies:

- Tigrinya (Native), English (Proficient), Arabic (Intermediate), Amharic (Fluent).

- Playing and watching Football (soccer), Reading, Running.